

Note: Draft minutes are subject to corrections, additions, and deletions

September 9, 2026

Present: Anne Marie Galanis, Chair
Alan Barclay
Scott Blair
Fred Diana
Patrick Sheridan
Don Bliss, Select Board Alternate Representative
Molly St. Jeanne, SAU 90 Representative
Absent (excused): Mike Plouffe; Bob Ladd, HBVD Representative

Meeting started at 9:05 am in Director Jen Hale's office in the administrative building of the Department of Public Works, 1 Hardardt's Way. Also present was Joe Lynch, Deputy Director

The Committee asked questions regarding the DPW facility study. An RFP for the study has been issued, and an internal needs assessment has been conducted with each department division. The study will assess current operations and propose options for what is needed to run efficiently and ensure employee safety.

The impact of the default budget was discussed. The Director noted that all area communities are facing similar pressures. Some projects have been delayed due to staff shortages and the need to reallocate existing staff to higher-priority needs, such as trash collection. Areas affected include changing street signs and addressing sewer, drainage, and catch basin issues.

The Capital Improvement Plan and the possibility and timing of a warrant to rebuild the DPW facility were also discussed. At this point, it is unclear when a warrant article will be presented to the voters.

Trash collection staffing and the current condition of the department's trucks were discussed. The truck approved by voters this year has been ordered.

The cost and process of obtaining a commercial driver's license (CDL) for staff were discussed. For those positions where it is a job requirement, the department pays for the training. The Director reported CDL training costs have increased significantly and she is working with the Fire Department to develop an in-house training program that will help reduce the costs.

This portion of the session ended at 9:50 a.m. Mr. Sheridan and Mr. Blair left the session.

Director Hale then took the remaining committee members on a tour of the garage and storage areas, as well as the sewer and drainage office area. At 10:45 am, Ms. St. Jeanne left the tour.

The remaining committee members met with Mike Carle and Mike Dube for a tour of the wastewater treatment plant. Plant operations and Phase 2 construction were discussed.

The tour concluded at 11:30 a.m.

Minutes prepared by A. M. Galanis